

Dimitri Knight on Taste in AI and What Designers Do Next



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Dimitri is a product designer who spent time at Cash App and Ramp, and is now on a deliberate career break — reading, thinking, and figuring out what design means in a world where AI can build the thing but can't decide if it's worth building.

We discuss:

- how he taught himself Photoshop at 11 through gaming forums and designed his first bank interface for a video game mod — a decade before working in FinTech
- what taste actually is and why AI can't have it

- how the designer role has quietly absorbed six other jobs over the last decade
- the iconic design choices that shaped how we interact with technology — from Apple and the iPhone to the Nintendo Wii — and why most people never noticed them
- why great customer service is a design problem that most companies treat as a cost center
- why the most important design challenges left might have nothing to do with software at all

00:00 Meet Dmitri

00:28 Photoshop Origins

01:48 Design vs Coding

04:10 Roleplay Mods to UI

09:30 Dropping Out Reset

12:53 Apple and Product Design

16:17 Generalist Designer Era

17:40 AI Slop and Taste

21:02 Tasteful vs Distasteful Brands

23:04 Aesthetics Versus Substance

24:54 Taste Icons Compared

26:30 Customer Service Trust

27:52 AI Commoditizes Software

29:18 Designing For Meaning

31:13 Quality Of Life Debate

34:02 Information And Revolutions

35:56 Voting And Local Community

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46:03 Gendered Founder Paths

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